FREE PRINTABLE

Crate Training Checklist



Before you start

☐ Crate is big enough to stand, turn around and lie down (use a divider as your puppy grows)
☐ Soft, washable bedding and one safe chew
☐ Placed in a quiet spot near the family
☐ Treats ready near the crate

7 calm steps

Step	What to do	Done
1	Leave the door open, toss treats inside, let your puppy explore	☐
2	Feed meals near, then inside the crate	☐
3	Say your cue ("crate") and reward when they step in	☐
4	Close the door for a few seconds, open, reward	☐
5	Build the time slowly while you stay close	☐
6	Move away for short periods, then return calmly	☐
7	Use the crate for naps and nights; always a potty trip after	☐

How long (daytime, awake)

Age	Common crate stretch
8 to 10 weeks	Up to about 1 hour
10 to 12 weeks	1 to 2 hours
3 to 4 months	2 to 3 hours
4 to 6 months	3 to 4 hours

Do

- Keep it calm and positive
- Reward quiet moments
- Go back a step if your puppy panics
- Take your puppy out right after

Don't

- Use the crate as punishment
- Leave a young puppy too long
- Let them out while crying (wait for a quiet moment)
- Force your puppy inside

Read the full guide: **puppyguido.com/blog/crate-training-a-puppy/**

General information only. Not veterinary advice.